

The Ten Commandments of Ethical Online Behavior

Rooted in Jewish Values • Informed by Youth Voices • Calibrated for the AI Era

PEOPLE

I Recognize the Divine

בְּצֶלֶם אֱלֹהִים

B'tzelem Elohim: Created in the Divine Image
"And God created the human in the Divine image" (Genesis 1:27).

What would change about your next comment, post, or share if you truly saw the person on the other end as someone created in the image of God?

II Guard Your Tongue

שְׁמִירַת הַלָּשׁוֹן

Shmirat HaLashon: Guarding One's Speech
"Death and life are in the power of the tongue" (Proverbs 18:21).

Before you hit send, ask: would I say this to someone's face, and does it matter who wrote the words?

III Honor and Protect Dignity

כְּבוֹד הָאָדָם

K'vod HaAdam: Human Dignity
Do not humiliate anyone publicly. The Talmud teaches that publicly shaming another person is akin to shedding blood (Bava Metzia 58b).

If you saw someone being attacked online right now, what would it take for you to step in?

IV Be a Mensch

דֶּרֶךְ אֶרֶץ • חֶסֶד

Derech Eretz: Common Decency • Chesed: Loving-Kindness
The Sages teach that derech eretz, basic decency and respect, comes before Torah itself (Vayikra Rabbah 9:3).

What is one way you could bring genuine chesed into someone's digital experience today?

V Seek Truth

אֱמֶת • גְּנִיבַת דָּעַת

Emet: Truth • Geneivat Da'at: Theft of Mind
The Torah commands: "Distance yourself from falsehood" (Exodus 23:7).

The next time you encounter content online, ask yourself: is this true, who made it, and is that transparent?

VI Protect Privacy

צְנִיעוּת

Tzniut: Modesty and Discretion
Judaism values modesty and discretion not as restriction but as protection of human dignity.

Before you share something online or enter it into an AI chatbot, ask: does this need to be shared, and do I know where it goes next?

VII Take Responsibility

עֲרֻבוֹת • יְגִיעָה

Arevut: Responsibility • Yegi'ah: The Toil of Learning
"All Israel are responsible for one another." Arevut means that what we do and create matters beyond ourselves.

The next time AI offers you a quick answer, ask: what would I learn by wrestling with this myself?

VIII Observe Digital Shabbat

שַׁבָּת

Shabbat: Sacred Rest and Boundaries
On the seventh day, God finished the work of creation and rested (Genesis 2:2). Practice stepping away from your screens.

What would it look like for you to practice a digital Shabbat, even for an hour?

IX Pursue Digital Justice

צְדָקָה

Tzedek: Justice and Righteousness
"Justice, justice shall you pursue" (Deuteronomy 16:20).

Before you build, post, or share, ask: who is this leaving out, and what can I do about it?

X Repair the World

תְּקוּן עוֹלָם • בַּל תַּשְׁחִית

Tikkun Olam: Repairing the World • Bal Tashchit: Do Not Destroy
Every post, share, and comment is an opportunity for tikkun, repair. Use your platform to uplift, educate, advocate, and create.

Ask yourself: is this use of technology truly serving tikkun, or is it just convenience at the world's expense?

INFORMATION

SELF & GROWTH

THE WORLD